

WRITE BETWEEN THE LINES



**How to Write Video Game Stories In a
Distracted, Polarized, Media Illiterate World**

Adam Dolin & Alexa Ray Corriea

ADAM DOLIN

Narrative Lead - Turtle Rock Studios (as of 2 months ago)

Writer - Narrative Designer - Creative Consultant - Teacher at ELVTR.com

Writing and Narrative Design

God of War (2018) - Horizon Forbidden West - God of War: Ragnarok - Netflix Games [cancelled stuff] - [A cool unannounced game] - Petal Runner (Playable here at Gamescom, Wishlist on Steam!)

Casting Coordinator

Here They Lie - Farpoint - Marvel: Spider-Man - Day's Gone - God of War (2018)

Dialogue Editing/Supervision

Uncharted 2: Among Thieves - Bulletstorm - XCOM: Enemy Unknown - The Bureau: XCOM Declassified - EVOLVE - Call of Duty: Advanced Warfare - Uncharted 4: A Thief's End



GameDevDolin.com

01: Why We Are Here

02: Polarization

03: The Attention Economy

04: Media Literacy

05: Takeaways

01: Why We Are Here

02: Polarization

03: The Attention Economy

04: Media Literacy

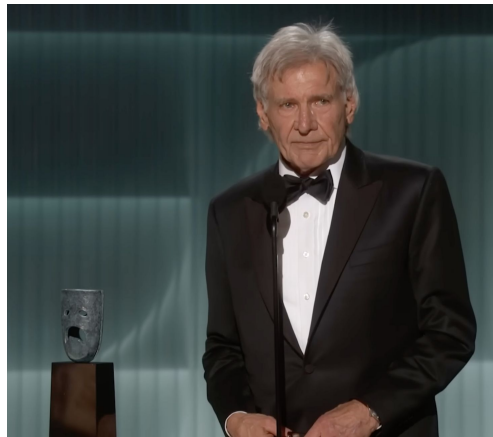
05: Takeaways

BECAUSE WE ARE FORTUNATE

"Sometimes we make entertainment; sometimes we make art.

Sometimes we're lucky to make 'em both at the same time.

And if we're *really* fortunate, we also get to make a living doing it."



– Harrison Ford

THE STATE OF THE INDUSTRY IN 2026



EPYLLION

By Matthew Ball

The State of Video Gaming in 2026
(Or “Growth and Where to Find It”)

Last Update: May 15, 2026
www.epyllion.co

WHY WE'RE HERE

THE STATE OF THE INDUSTRY IN 2026

according to:



“Video gaming’s post-pandemic problem isn’t that players choose to watch TikTok instead of buy a AAA game...

...it’s that on a Friday evening, players are placing a growing share of their time and spend *elsewhere*.”

SOURCE: Matthew Ball’s State of the Video Gaming Industry - 2026

Video Games Europe

KEY FACTS REPORT 2024

VIDEOGAMES EUROPE⁺



European
Games Developer
Federation



The polling is done in France, UK, Spain, Italy and Germany. It involves online polling of 12,000 people per country between the ages of 6 and 64 – 60,000 in total per year.

There is also an annual face-to-face survey of 1,000 people per country which is nationally representative (in terms of age, gender and region). This final step is used to calibrate the online data.

ON AVERAGE, PEOPLE IN EUROPE SPEND



9.4 hours/week

playing video games



16.75 hours /week

on social media*



23 hours/week

on watching TV**

*GlobalWebIndex GWI Report on the time spent on social media platforms by a "typical" user.

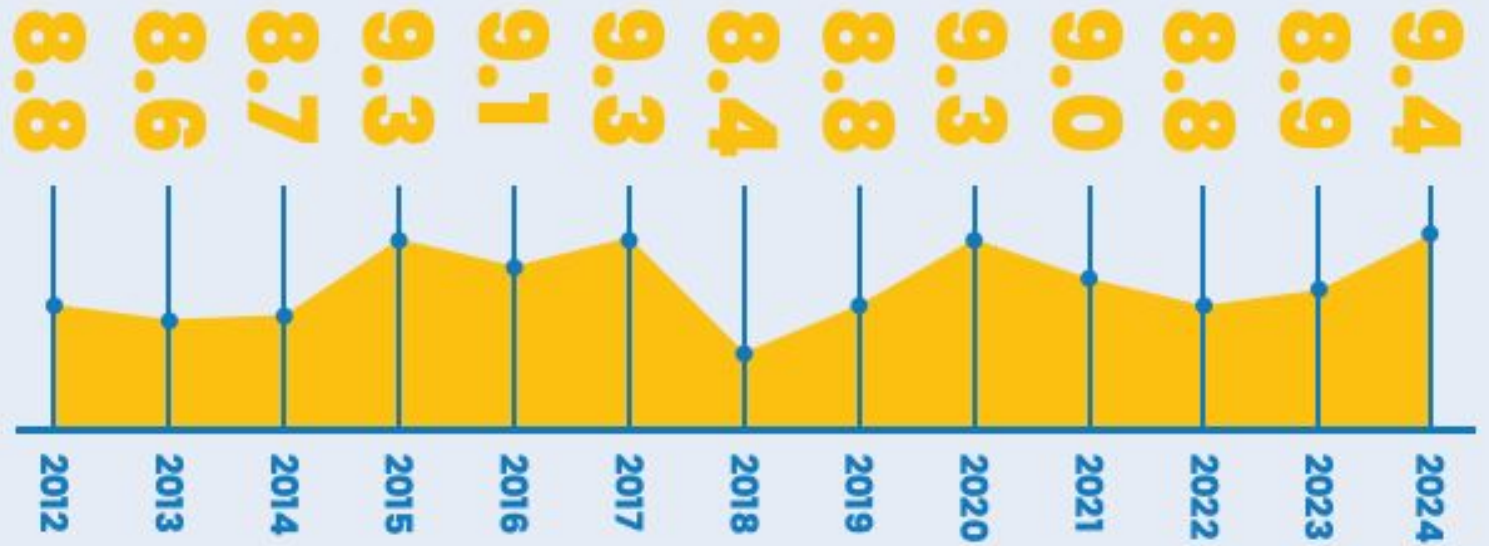
**Thinkbox TV Viewing Report 2024. Time spent watching TV broadcast plus SVOD & AVOD.

WHY WE'RE HERE

AVERAGE PLAY TIME BY COUNTRY IN 2024

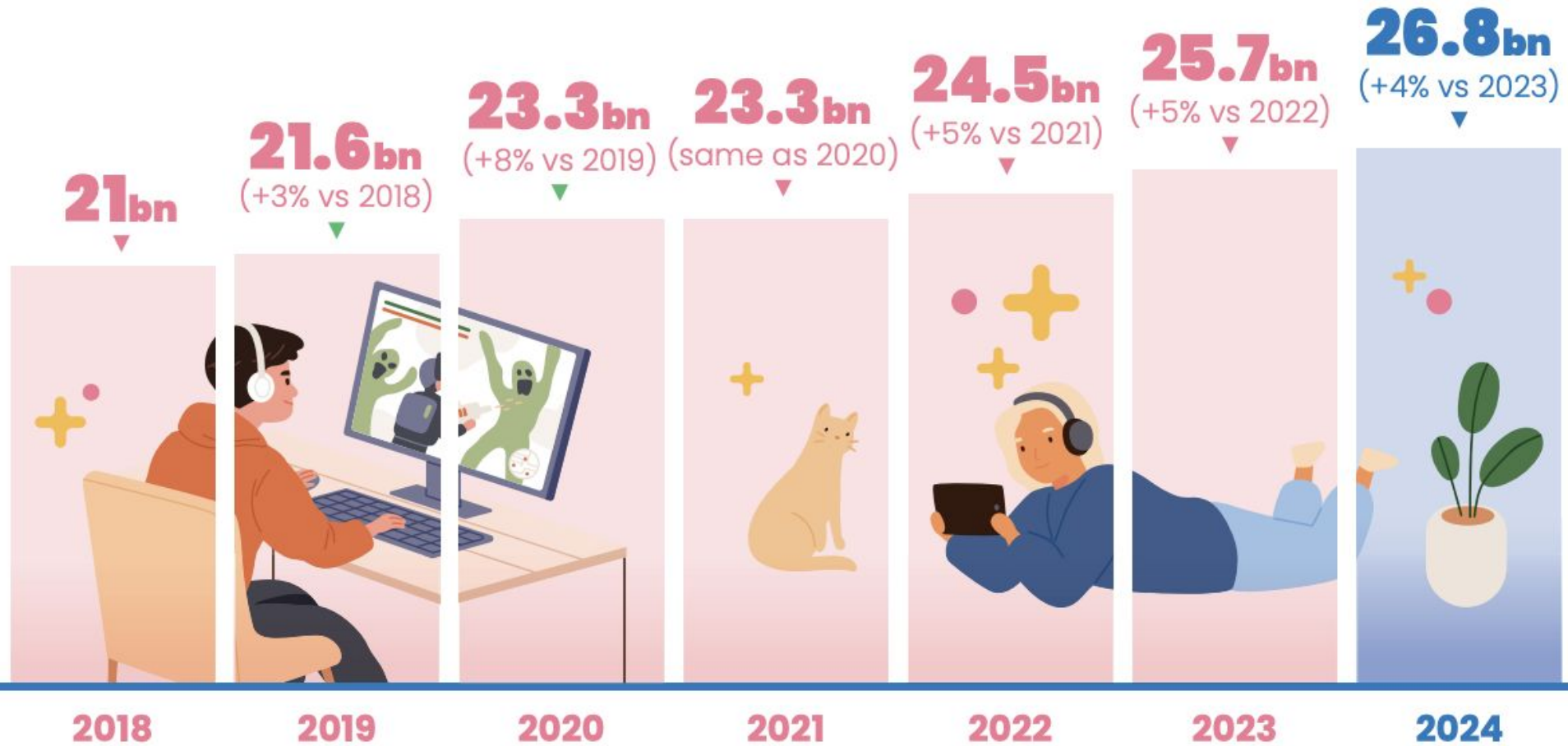


AVERAGE PLAYTIME IN HOURS PER WEEK (2012 – 2024)



WHY WE'RE HERE

REVENUE IN THE EUROPEAN MARKET



WHY WE'RE HERE

PlayStation will shutter London Studio, they look to lay off 'about 900' employees around the globe

News By Dashiell Wood | Published February 27, 2024

A tough year gets tougher

Embracer confirms it's laid off over 1,000 people since the start of its restructuring program

News By Catherine Lewis | Published February 15, 2024

The program is now "nearing completion"

Europe's game developers took a hit in 2023 – and the pain's not over

A new report shows Europe's video game developers earned less in 2023, with the trade body warning about upcoming EU consumer protection rules

Maximilian Henning  Euractiv



Ubisoft closes another studio, announces layoffs at 3 more as part of 'ongoing efforts to prioritize projects and reduce costs'

News By Andy Chalk | Published 27 January 2025

The closure of Ubisoft Leamington and layoffs at the Düsseldorf, Stockholm, and Reflections studios will see 185 people put out of work.

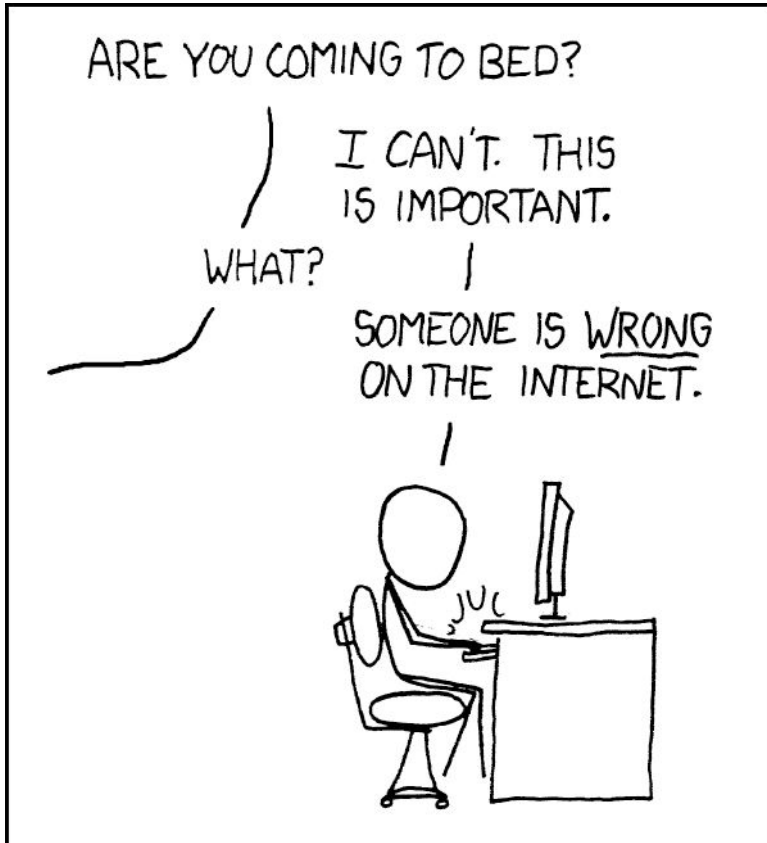
Blade creator Ninja Theory / Double Fine are also in 'active' negotiations to go off.

Two Interactive Shuts Down Two Studios

cept Games and London's Roll7 will be closed.

er
02 PM PDT
1, 2024 at 1:24 PM PDT

THE STATE OF DISCOURSE IN 2026



xkcd.com/386

"Is the writing actually bad or are you just trying to order a milkshake from Home Depot?"



bumblebeebats

THE ACTUAL RISK OF TAKING RISKS



WHY WE'RE HERE

EXECUTIVE TRENDS

- Mass layoffs following record profits
- Pivoting to live-service
- Overexpansion during pandemic growth
- Studio consolidation and acquisitions
- New IP risk avoidance

Bungie CEO Seemingly Spent Over \$2.3 Million On Classic Cars After Sony Acquisition

Some are calling on Pete Parsons to resign after another round of devastating layoffs

Halo Windows Games

By **Ethan Gach**

Published July 31, 2024 | [🔗](#)

Comparing annual compensation for EA's CEO and Workers (SHORT version - 2026)

The top lines show EA CEO Andrew Wilson's annual compensation from 2018-2026 (his reported compensation and his "actually paid" compensation). Bottom line shows EA workers' median pay.

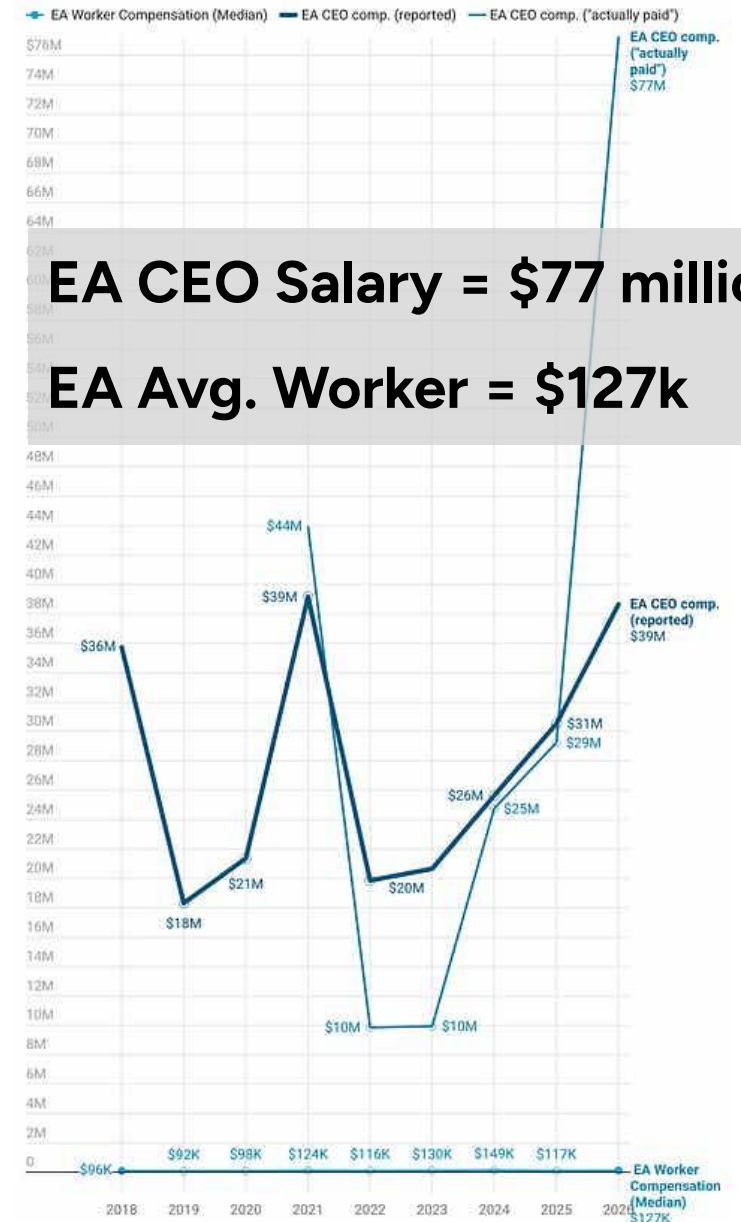


Chart: Game File • Source: Electronic Arts SEC filings • Created with Datawrapper

DIFFERENT PRIORITIES

EXECUTIVES

- Run a profitable business
- Ship the game on time and on budget
- Provide a safe work environment

AUDIENCES

- To Be Entertained
- To Escape
- To Feel Something



CREATIVES

- To Make Art
- To Say Something
- To Earn a Living

VALUES?

Values are subjective.

Values impact how you behave under pressure.

Values determine where you compromise, and where you fight.



WHY WE'RE HERE

WHAT ARE YOUR VALUES?

Achievement	Adventure	Fitness	Flexibility	Nature	Order
Assertiveness	Authenticity	Freedom	Friendliness	Patience	Peace
Beauty	Challenge	Forgiveness	Fun	Pleasure	Power
Community	Conformity	Generosity	Gratitude	Resilience	Romance
Courage	Creativity	Honesty	Humor	Safety	Self-development
Curiosity	Empathy	Humility	Independence	Sensuality	Sexuality
Encouragement	Equality	Integrity	Intimacy	Simplicity	Spirituality
Fairness	Family	Kindness	Leadership	Stability	Tradition
		Legacy	Love	Trust	Wealth
		Loyalty	Mindfulness	Wisdom	Suggest a value

WHY WE'RE HERE

OUR VALUES

“By centering values when building technology, we help manifest outcomes aligned with those values.”

— Center for Humane Technology, 2024

Curiosity

To be curious, open-minded and interested; to explore and discover

Empathy

To understand and share the feelings of others

Fun

To be fun-loving; to seek, create, and engage in fun-filled activities

Adam's Core Values

Empathy

To understand and share the feelings of others

Courage

To be courageous or brave; to persist in the face of fear, threat, or difficulty

Community

To be part of and actively contribute to my community

Alexa's Core Values

CORPORATE VALUES

NETFLIX JOBS

PEOPLE OVER PROCESS

You get better outcomes when employees have the information and freedom to make decisions for themselves. We hire unusually responsible people who thrive on this openness and freedom.

UNCOMFORTABLY EXCITING

To entertain the world, we need to be bold and ambitious. That means embracing the thrill of what's next — even when it's uncomfortable.

THE DREAM TEAM

We aim only to have high performers at Netflix — people who are great at what they do, and even better at working together.

GREAT AND ALWAYS BETTER

We often say Netflix sucks today compared to where we can be tomorrow. We need the self-awareness to understand what should

 **RIOT GAMES**

OUR VALUES

WE ARE PLAYER FIRST

Be part of the community

Hyper-serve the core

Foster a thriving ecosystem

Support players everywhere

PERSONAL VALUES vs. CORPORATE VALUES



WHY WE'RE HERE

VALUES - TAKEAWAYS

- ❑ **Know your own values.** Recognize when they're being tested.
- ❑ **Know your studio's values.** Understand where they align with yours and where they don't.
- ❑ **Values-based conflicts don't always have a clean resolution.**

01: Why We Are Here

02: Polarization

03: The Attention Economy

04: Media Literacy

05: Takeaways

01: Why We Are Here

02: Polarization

03: The Attention Economy

04: Media Literacy

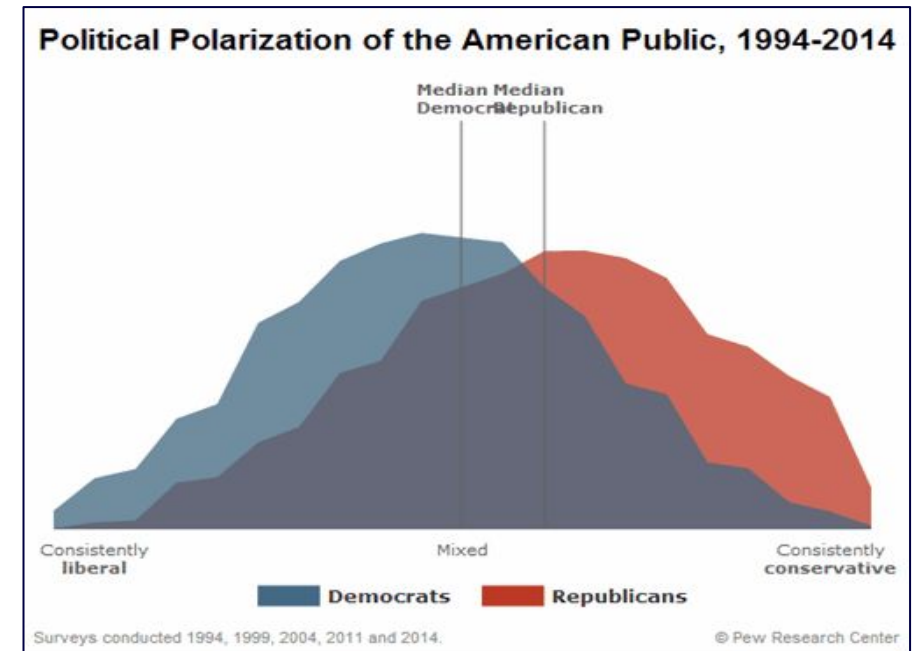
05: Takeaways

THE SOCIAL MEDIA EFFECT

In 2008, fewer than 1 in 8 Americans got news from social media.

By 2019, it was over 70%.

— Levy, "Social Media, News Consumption, and Polarization,"
American Economic Review, 2021



TOO MUCH NEWS

“The fact that there are so many sources means we cannot consume them all.

And so we become selective in our own ways, which results in polarization.”

— Manshadi et al., “Information Inundation on Platforms and Implications,” Yale School of Management

POLARIZATION - EURO-STYLE

Political Polarization and Gridlock in Europe: New Evidence from High Frequency Indices

SUERF Policy Brief | No. 1290 | 30 Oct, 2025

source:

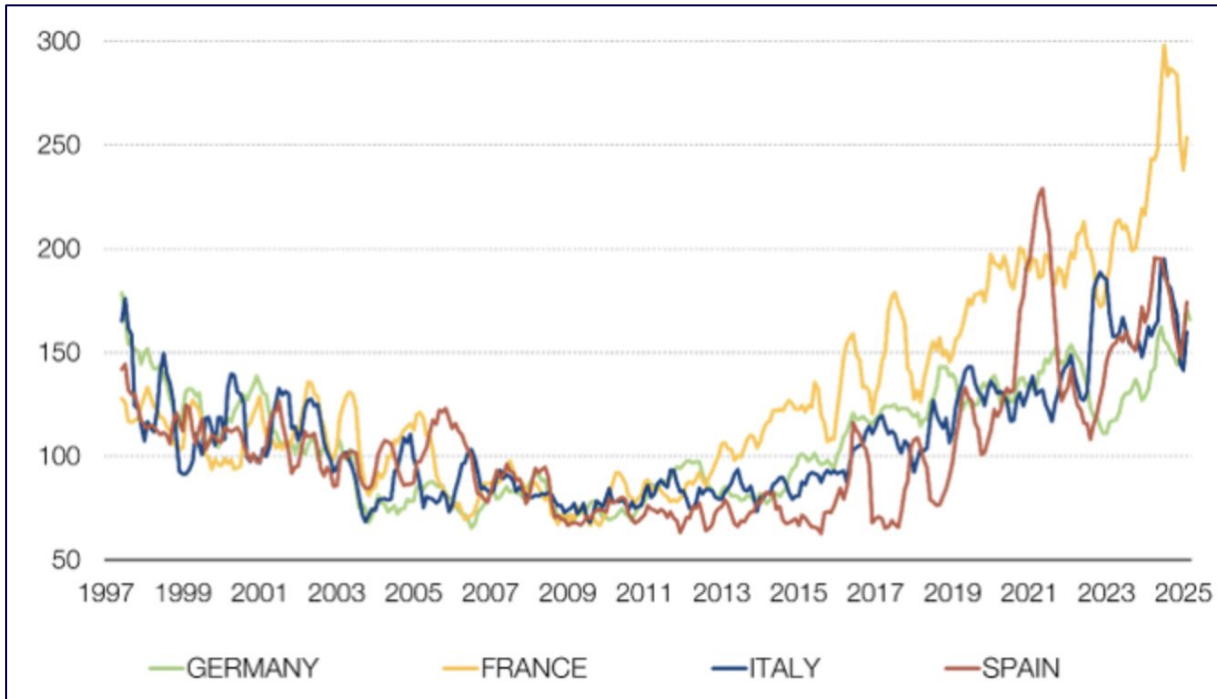


Figure 1. Political Polarization Index

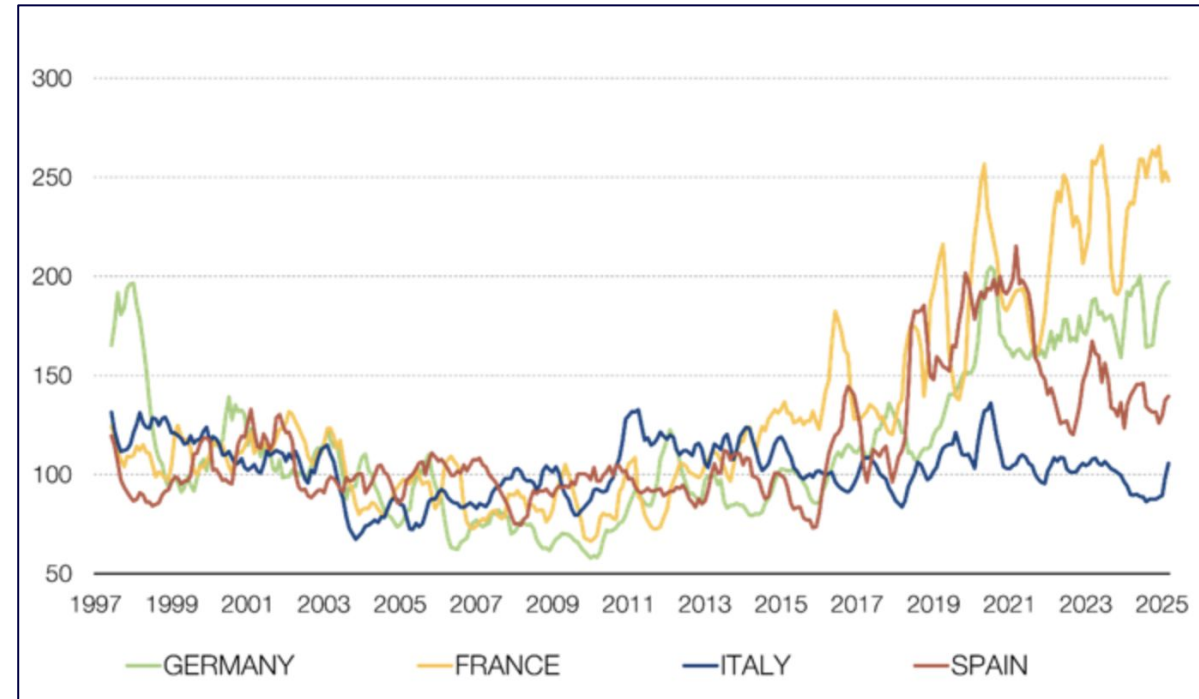


Figure 2. Legislative Gridlock Index

WHY WE'RE HERE

POLARIZATION

TANGENT ALERT

Weaponizing the haters: *The Last Jedi* and the strategic politicization of pop culture through social media manipulation
by Morten Bay

f i ® s t m x ñ d @ ¥
PEER-REVIEWED JOURNAL ON THE INTERNET

How Russia Turns Gamers into Fighters

Galen Lamphere-Englund and Petra Regeni

13 February 2026

The Kremlin's weaponization of video games for recruitment and influence is no longer a theoretical risk. To protect the digital commons, the West must treat gaming as a core frontier of contemporary hybrid warfare.



A RAY OF HOPE

“...participants exposed to counter-attitudinal news learned to rationalize the opinions of the opposing party.

Intuitively, participants may have learned some of the opposing party’s arguments and thus understood better why that party supports certain positions.

This led to more positive attitudes but did not change political opinions”

— Levy, American Economic Review, 2021.

DETROIT: BECOME HUMANE

"Taking the perspective of a gendered violence victim in a video game increases player's embodiment toward the game character, and, in turn, increases player's cognitive empathy toward gendered violence victims."

Video games for good: Active perspective-taking fosters empathy and reduces implicit bias toward gendered violence victims

Sweeney Jing Li, Zeph M.C. van Berlo *

Amsterdam School of Communication Research (ASCoR), University of Amsterdam, Amsterdam, the Netherlands



(A) PATH OUT (TO EMPATHY)

"...after 30 min of game play embodying a Syrian refugee, **participants showed reduced prejudicial attitudes and increased empathy towards Syrian refugees** compared to those playing a mechanically similar but contextually unrelated game."

SOURCE: Cross, Atherton & Stiff, "A Path Out: Using Video Games to Reduce Prejudice Towards Refugees," Behavioral Sciences, 2025.
University of Plymouth / Keele University.



A "SAFE" STORY...

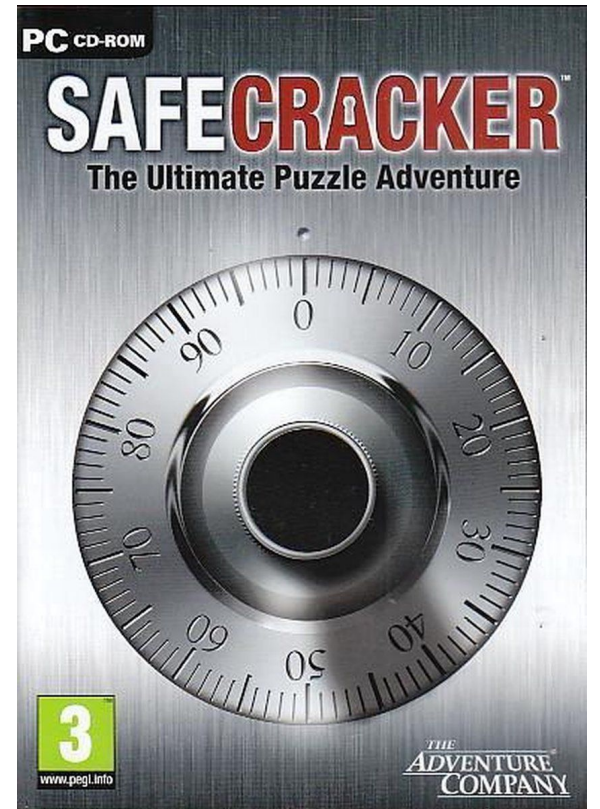
Doesn't make a strong thematic argument.

Doesn't challenge the player's values.

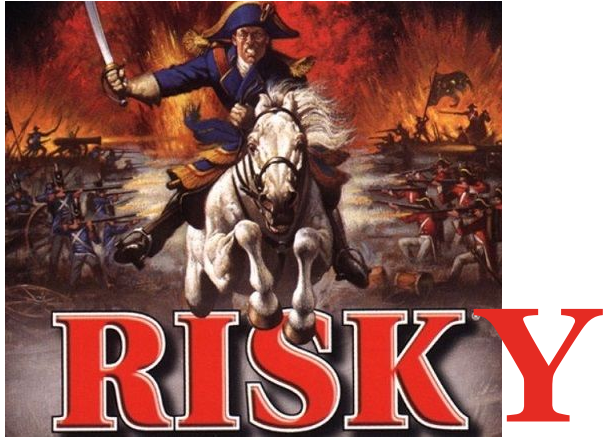
Leans on familiar tropes.

Avoids "unlikeable" characters.

Tries very, very hard not to upset ANYONE.



A



STORY...

Makes a strong thematic argument.

Challenges the player's values.

Subverts genre expectations.

Trusts the audience to engage with discomfort.

Risks alienating some players to deeply resonate with others.

IT'S OKAY TO DISAGREE



WHY WE'RE HERE

POLARIZATION

CRITIQUE

Nuanced.
Goal-oriented.
Good-faith.



BACKLASH

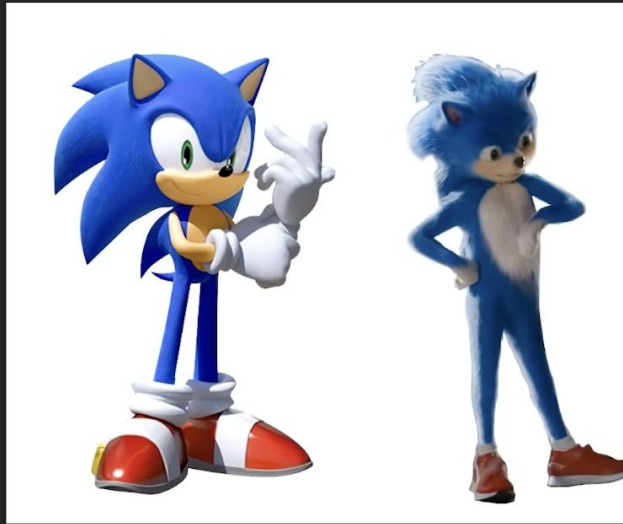
Emotional.
Reactive.
Loud.





CRITIQUE

BACKLASH



How to Fix the Sonic Design and Why is



FlippedNormals

341K subscribers

Join

Subscribe



@sirkowski · Mar 4, 2019
ails from #Sonic.



SONIC SAYS:

Oh god. Where are my fucking gloves. They just made my hands white. Why couldn't they just give me fucking gloves

roxas.best.boy

SONIC THE HEDGEHOG'S
**TERRIFYING
HUMAN TEETH**





CRITIQUE

BACKLASH



SCREEN RANT

10 Real Problems With The Acolyte (No, We're Not Talking About It Being "Woke")

The Acolyte review: Atrociously cruel dialogue holds back a refreshing take on Star Wars

★★★★☆

Ed Power
Tuesday 04 June 2024 17:00 BST



The Acolyte suffers from a near absence of compelling characters and some dramatic lapses of subtlety.
— Keith Phipps, TV Guide

The series doesn't quite seem to know what to do with more than a handful of its ensemble members.
— Angie Han, Hollywood Reporter

The characters here are thinly drawn, often weighed down by overly functional dialogue.
— James Dyer, Empire Magazine



'Star Wars' Show 'The Acolyte' Blames Critics' For Cancellation

The critics are 'snake oil salesmen' and 'opportunists' in new interview

PM EST • Updated November 25, 2025 7:35 PM EST

THE MESSY MIDDLE



"as many fans as possible" — Matt Leslye Headland for making The Acolyte the gayest Star Wars show yet"

By Vaishnavi Sah | Published Jul 15, 2025 04:18 GMT

WORTH REPEATING:

- ❑ Someone else's dislike of something doesn't mean you're wrong for loving it.
- ❑ Your love for something doesn't invalidate someone's dislike of it.
- ❑ When you release art into the world, you no longer have control over it.
- ❑ The commercial and critical success of your art is not a reflection of your worth as a human being.

POLARIZATION: TAKEAWAYS

- ❑ Trying to play it safe in a polarized market is a risky bet.
- ❑ Figure out what you want to say. (HINT: Look to your values)
- ❑ Let your players *participate* in the meaning, instead of lecturing them.
- ❑ Recognize the difference between backlash and critique.

HEY

Listen!



Let's talk about attention.



01: Why We Are Here

02: Polarization

03: The Attention Economy

04: Media Literacy

05: Takeaways

01: Why We Are Here

02: Polarization

03: The Attention Economy

04: Media Literacy

05: Takeaways

OUR DIGITAL WAKING LIFE

US Adults Will Spend 12:55 a Day With Media in 2026 via a Multitude of Disparate Activities
average hrs:mins spent per day with total media by US adults, by media/platform, 2026

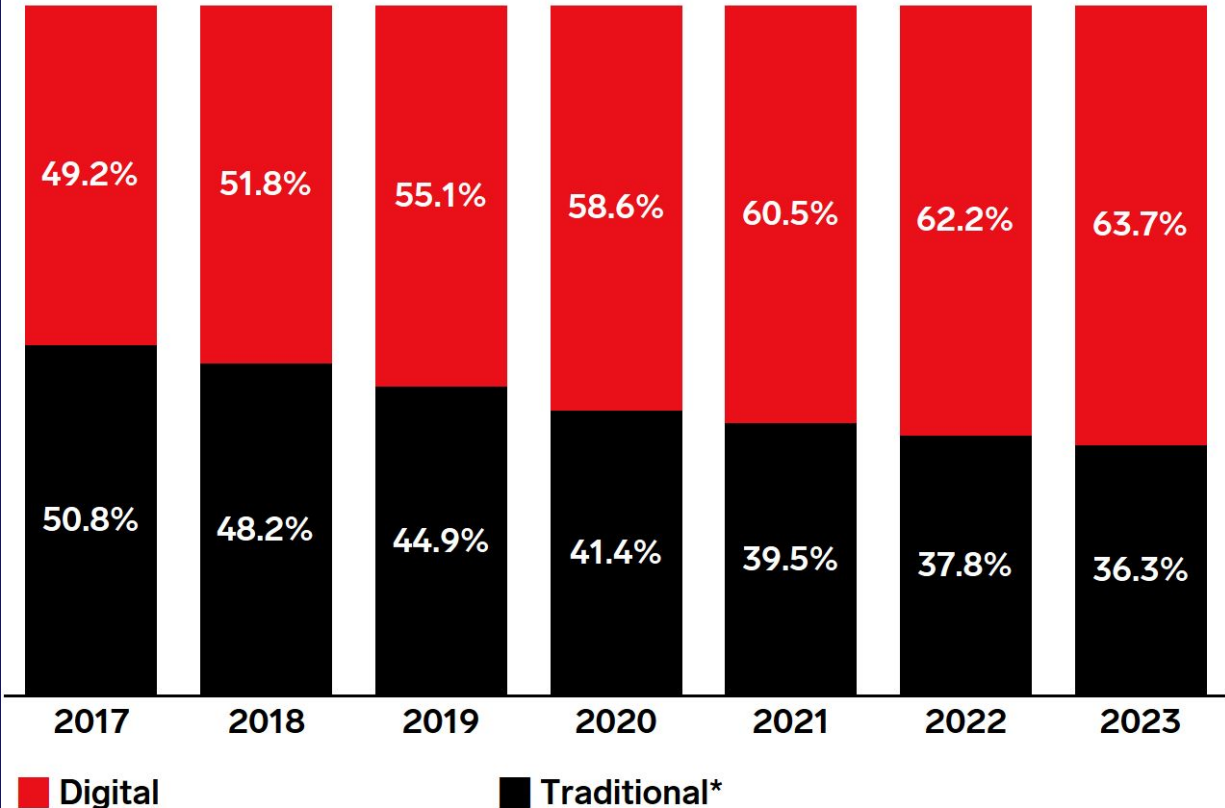
Note: ages 18+; includes time spent with digital internet activities (desktop/laptop, nonvoice mobile, connected TV, and other connected devices), print, radio, TV, and other traditional media including printed catalogs, direct mail, cinema, and out-of-home; "other digital nonvideo" includes ecommerce shopping, checking email, accessing fintech services, using fitness apps, checking maps, and reading the news; "other digital video" includes esports, news videos, educational videos, and adult content
Source: EMARKETER Forecast, Dec 2025

358806

EM | EMARKETER

— Source: eMarketer, "US Time Spent With Media 2025," February 2025

Traditional* vs. Digital Media: Share of Average Time Spent in the US, 2017-2023
% of total



WHY WE'RE HERE

POLARIZATION

ATTENTION

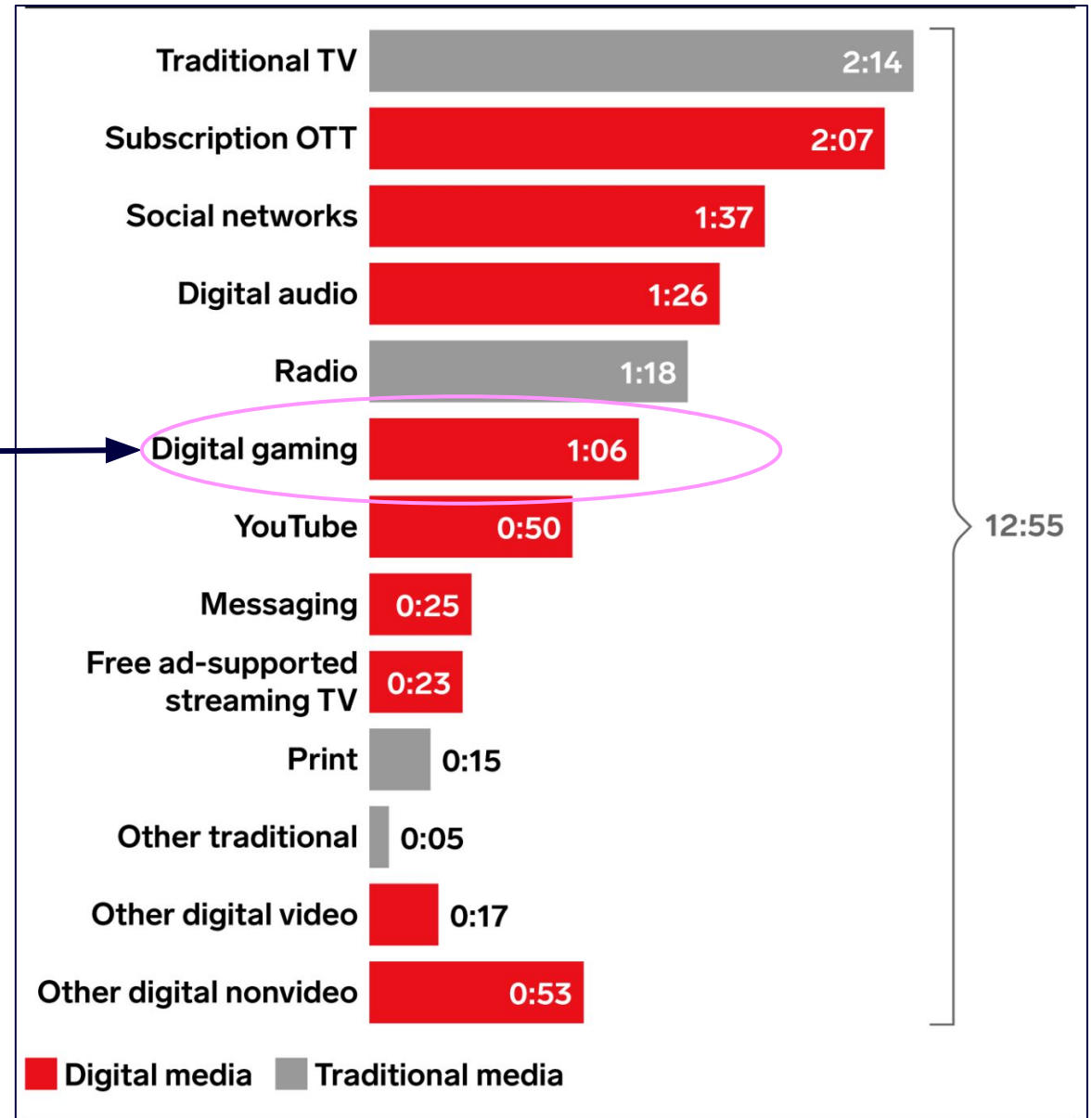
OUR DIGITAL WAKING LIFE

1:06 hours of daily
gaming on average

— SOURCE: eMarketer, "US Time Spent
With Media 2025," February 2025

"...on a Friday evening, players
are placing a growing share of
their time and spend *elsewhere*."

—SOURCE: Matthew Ball's State of the Video Gaming
Industry - 2026



WHY WE'RE HERE

POLARIZATION

ATTENTION

THE ATTENTION ARMS RACE

- Short-form social feeds
- Prediction markets, online gambling, crypto trading
- Video streaming services
- Subscription-based content creators
- AI-generated everything



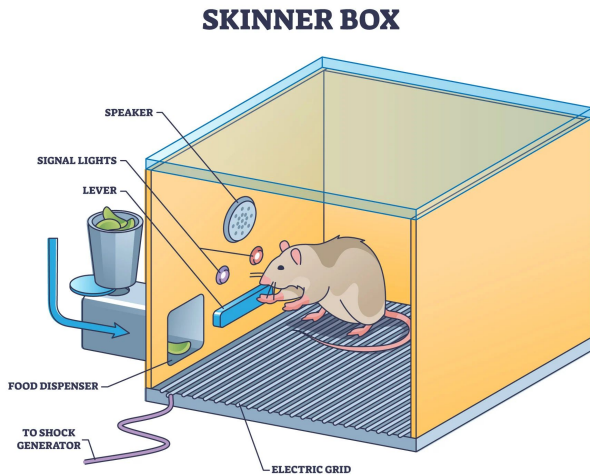
WHY WE'RE HERE

POLARIZATION

ATTENTION

DARK PATTERNS

- Variable rewards beat predictable ones
- Perfected by slot machines, industrialized by social media
- The default architecture of feeds, notifications, and loot boxes



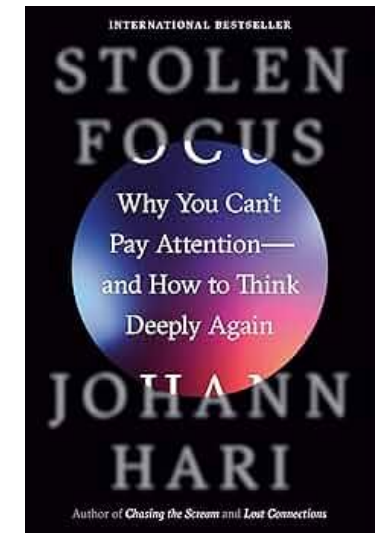
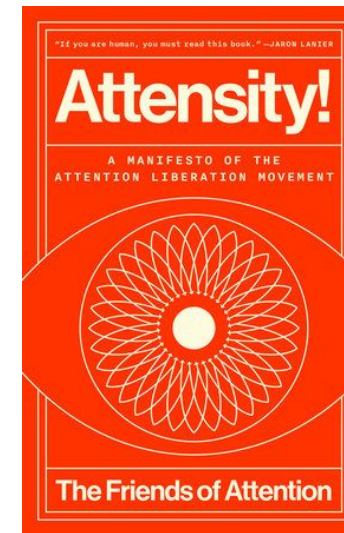
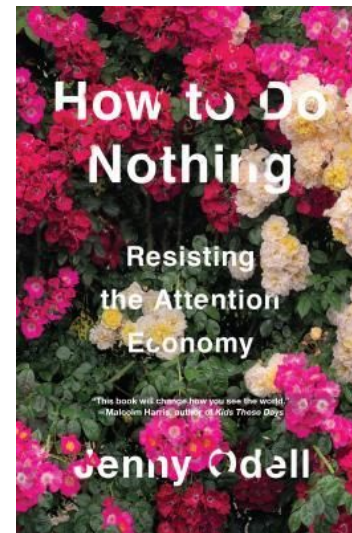
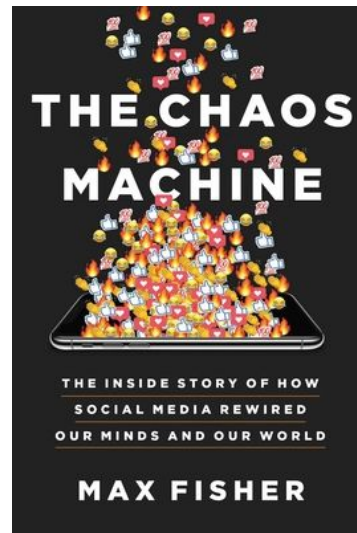
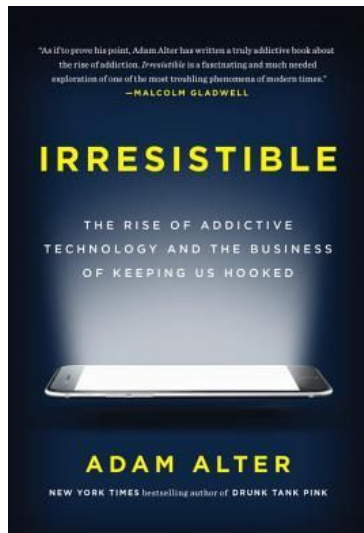
WHY WE'RE HERE

POLARIZATION

ATTENTION

WAIT...

WHAT WERE WE TALKING ABOUT?



Review

Exploring the Impact of Internet Use on Memory and Attention Processes

Received: 5 November 2020; Accepted: 16 December 2020; Published: 17 December 2020



healthcare

Article

The Struggle for Human Attention: Between the Abuse of Social Media and Digital Wellbeing



WHY WE'RE HERE

POLARIZATION

ATTENTION

STRATEGIES FOR NARRATIVE SUCCESS

Layered Storytelling

Rewarding Curiosity

Strategic Brevity

WHY WE'RE HERE

POLARIZATION

ATTENTION

LAYERED STORYTELLING

- **Art and Environment:** Show, don't tell. Use the environment to carry narrative.
- **Audio:** Leitmotifs, Thematic Sound Design
- **Design:** Gameplay/UI/UX choices to guide player's emotions
- **Actors & Performance Directors:** Deeper integration with dev teams = More informed performances



2 Important Rules:

- Great story ideas can come from anywhere.
- Dialogue can't solve everything!

REWARD CURIOSITY

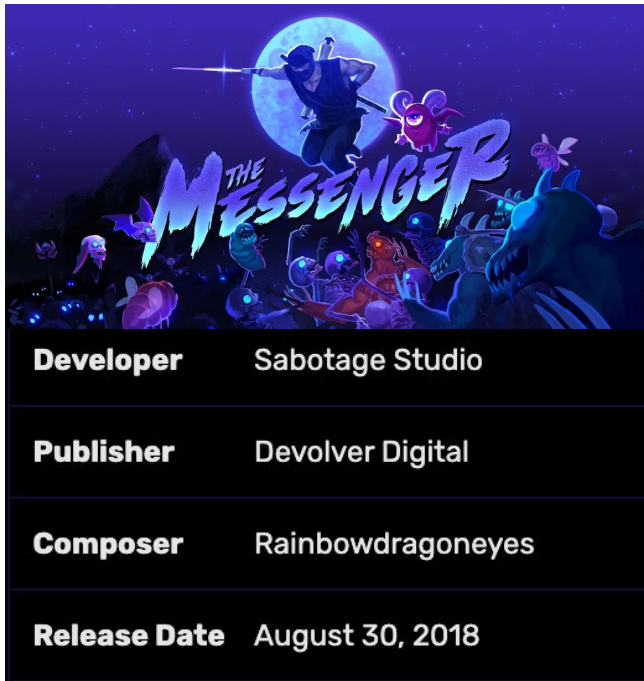


WHY WE'RE HERE

POLARIZATION

ATTENTION

THE MESSENGER



WHY WE'RE HERE

POLARIZATION

ATTENTION

BUT... WHAT'S IN THE CABINET?



WHY WE'RE HERE

POLARIZATION

ATTENTION

FOR THOSE WHO BOTHER LOOKING



The Fake Ending Was Better

Beat the game

29.7%



Fine, I Won't Open It

Be lectured on happiness

41.4%



Did I ever tell you about the guy who stayed late on a Friday night and started writing optional dialogue to "add comedic value for those who will bother looking" ?

WHY WE'RE HERE

POLARIZATION

ATTENTION

STRATEGIC BREVITY



Meaningless Choices and Impractical Advice (Notes from a *Disco Elysium* writer)

Justin Keenan
Writer, ZA/UM Studio



WHY WE'RE HERE

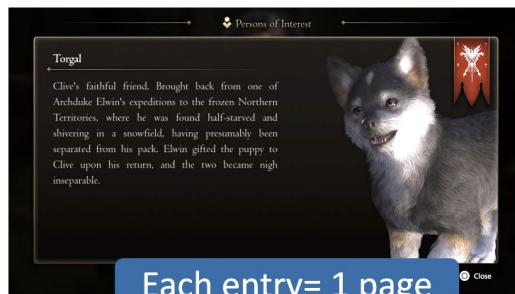
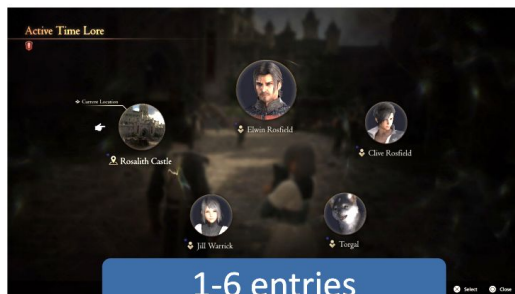
POLARIZATION

ATTENTION

EXPOSITION DESIGN

How did we design ATL?

Short, brief and limited information



© SQUARE ENIX

MARCH 18-22, 2024 #GDC2024



Test case

New countries:

The Dhalmekian Republic, The Iron Kingdom

The Kingdom of Waloea

The Holy Empire of Sanbreque

New places:

Nysa Defile, Fort Zirnitra

New characters:

Wyvern, Tiamat, Hugo, Benedikta, Barnabas, +more

Unique terms:

Dominant, Shiva (Eikon) +more

Where is Rosaria??
I heard that
Clive was from Rosaria!



The politics are
too complex!
And this is just
the prologue!!!

© SQUARE ENIX

MARCH 18-22, 2024 #GDC2024



Designing Active Time Lore for
'Final Fantasy XVI'

Momoka Aono
Game Designer
SQUARE ENIX CO., LTD.

WHY WE'RE HERE

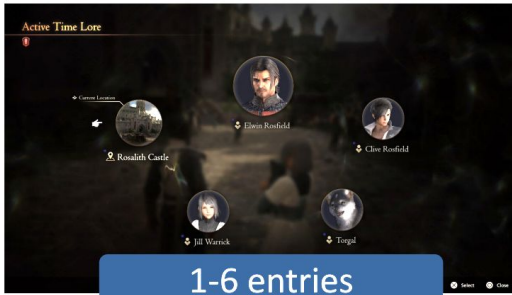
POLARIZATION

ATTENTION

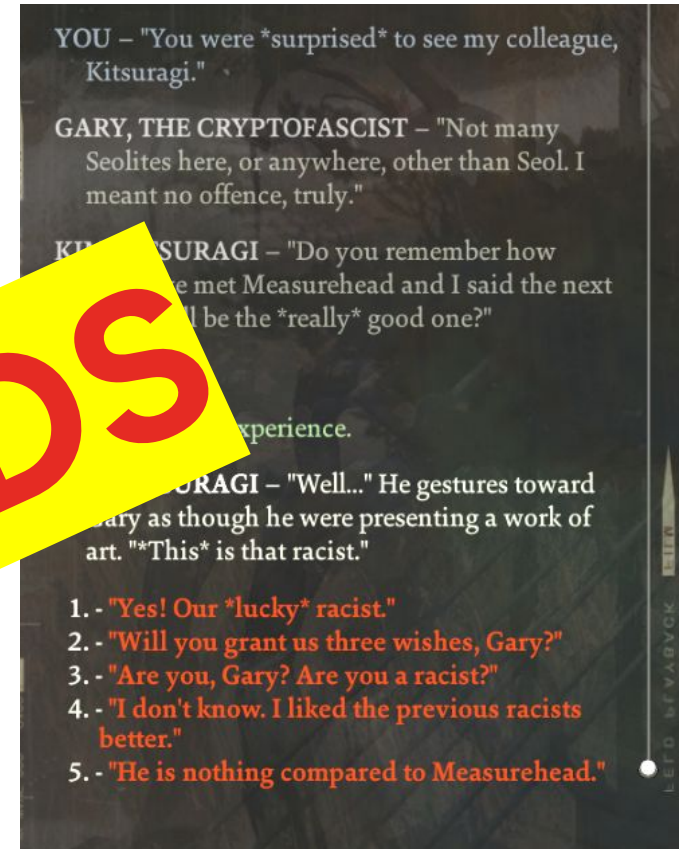
WHICH IS BETTER?

How did we design ATL?

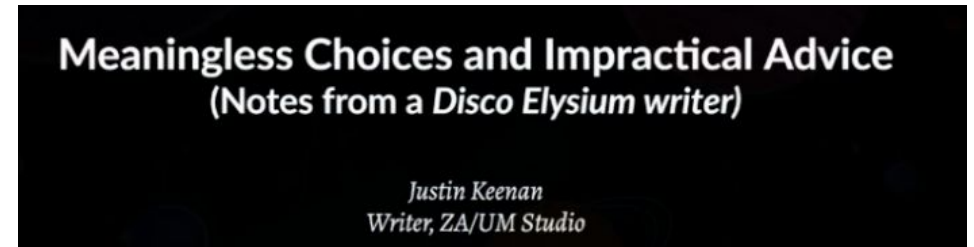
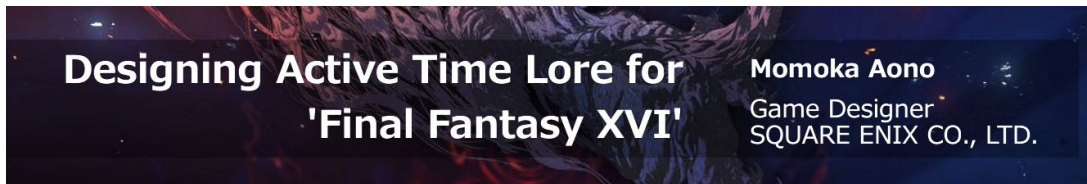
Short, brief and limited information



IT DEPENDS



MARCH 18-22, 2024 #GDC2024 © SQUARE ENIX GDC



WHY WE'RE HERE

POLARIZATION

ATTENTION

THE ATTENTION ECONOMY - TAKEAWAYS

❑ Design for narrative depth.

- Cross-disciplinary collaborate for layered storytelling



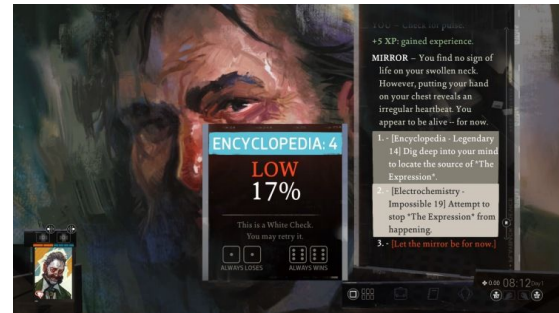
❑ Reward player curiosity.

- Hide surprising and delightful content
- Be okay with the fact some players might never see it



❑ Less text ≠ shallow story.

- Be strategic with your text layouts.
- Walls of text are visually intimidating.



**How you display text
and how your players interact with it
is equally important as the text itself.**

❏ Less text ≠ shallow story.

- Be strategic with your text layouts.
- Walls of text are visually intimidating.

01: Why We Are Here

02: Polarization

03: The Attention Economy

04: Media Literacy

05: Takeaways

01: Why We Are Here

02: Polarization

03: The Attention Economy

04: Media Literacy

05: Takeaways

WHAT IS MEDIA LITERACY?

The ability or skills to critically analyze for accuracy, credibility, or evidence of bias, the content created and consumed in various media, including games, TV, film, the internet, literature, and social media.



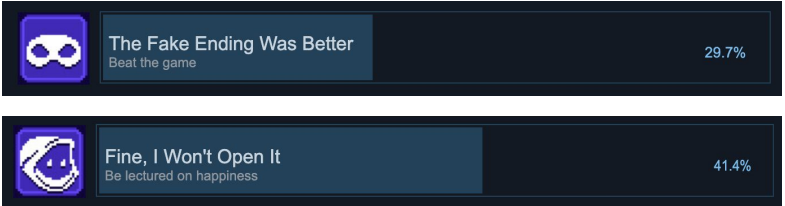
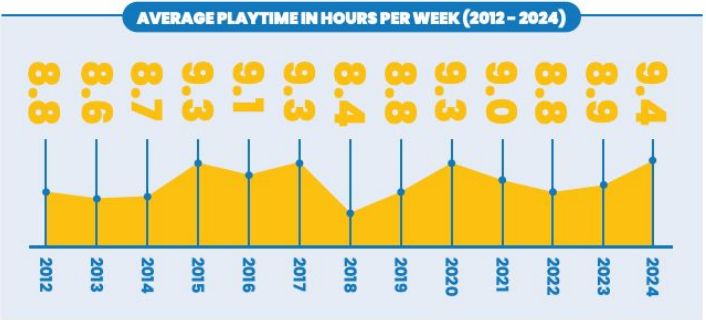
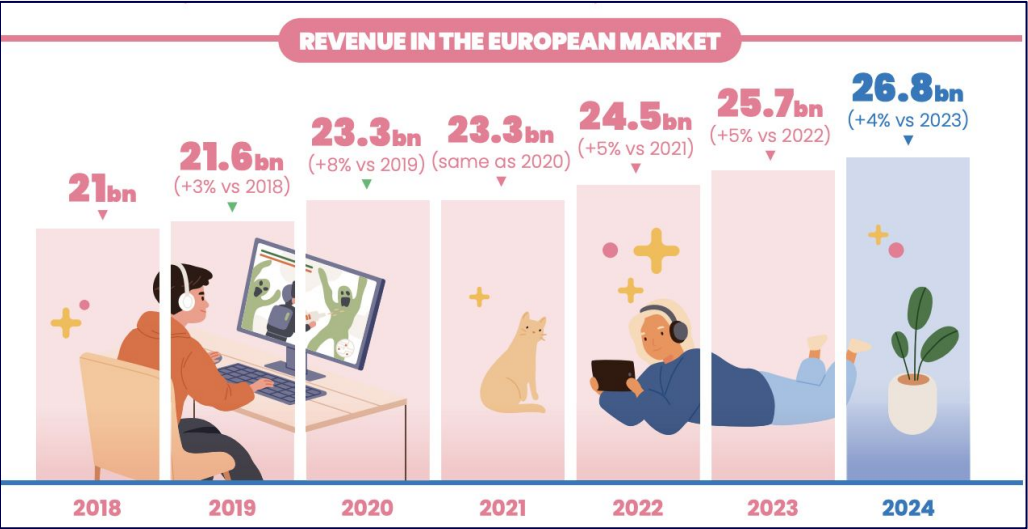
The ability to critically analyze the media you consume.

BUT HOW CAN WE, AS GAME WRITERS, INCREASE PLAYERS' MEDIA LITERACY?

❏ **Increase your own level of media literacy.**

Research is a writer's best friend.

THE DETAILS IN THE DATA



Comparing annual compensation for EA's CEO and Workers (SHORT version - 2026)

The top lines show EA CEO Andrew Wilson's annual compensation from 2018-2026 (his reported compensation and his "actually paid" compensation). Bottom line shows EA workers' median pay.

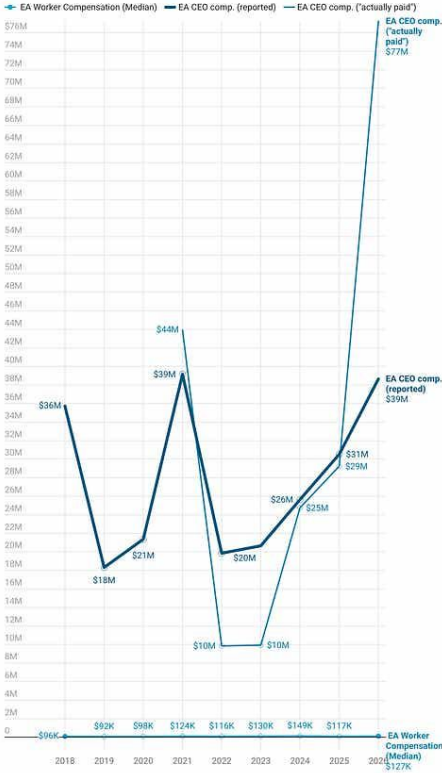
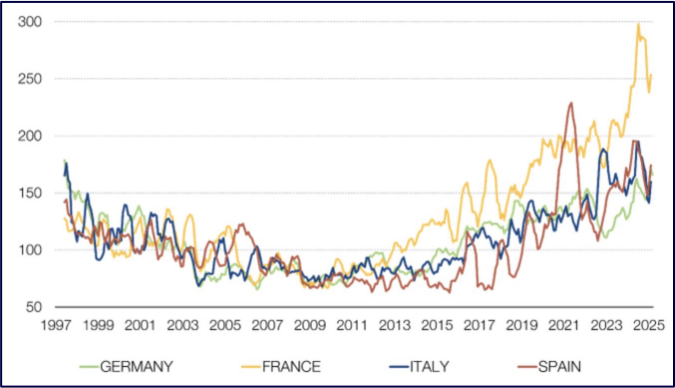
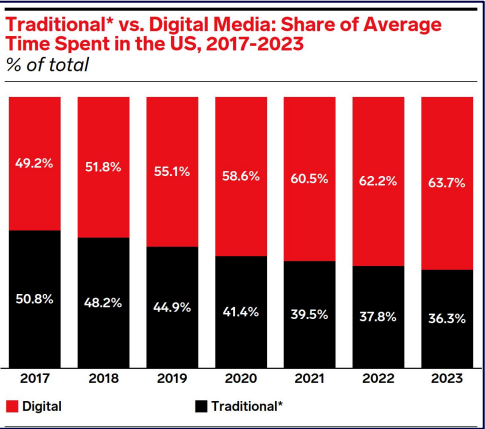
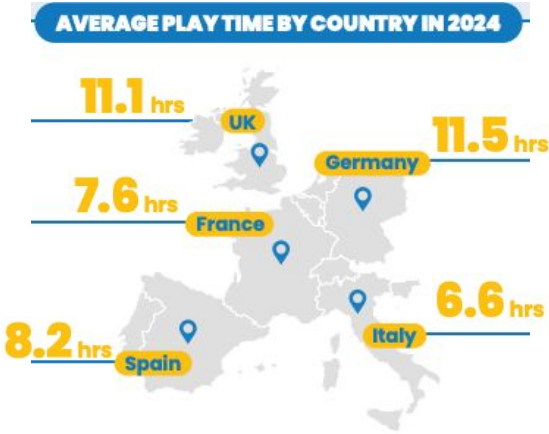


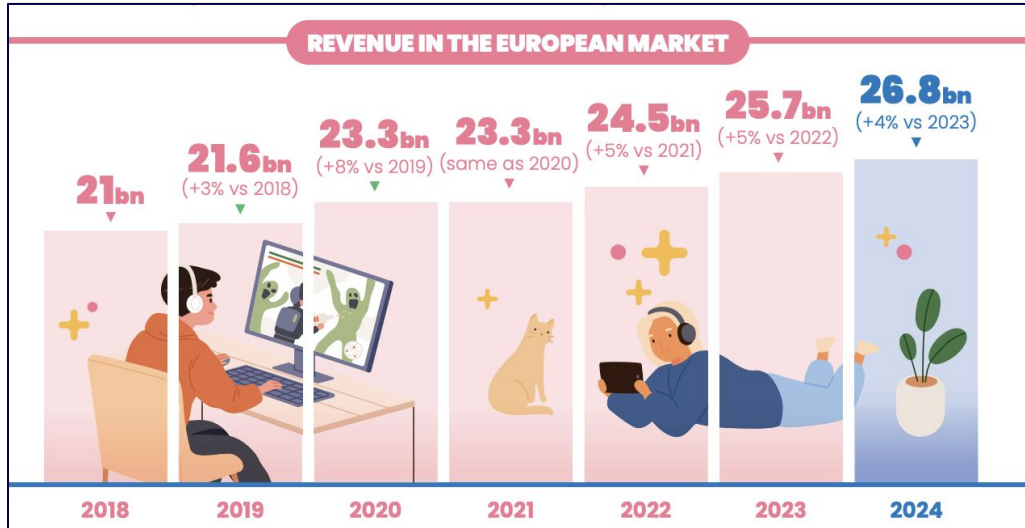
Chart: Game File • Source: Electronic Arts SEC Filings • Created with Dataswapper



*GlobalWebIndex GWI Report on the time spent on social media platforms by a "typical" user.
**Thinkbox TV Viewing Report 2024. Time spent watching TV broadcast plus SVOD & AVOD.



QUESTION EVERYTHING



← This chart does not represent:

- ❑ Inflation
- ❑ How much revenue went to Roblox, Fortnite, Steam, Apple, mobile games, etc.
- ❑ Consumer Spending ≠ Studio Profit



SOURCE: Cross, Atherton & Stiff, "A Path Out: Using Video Games to Reduce Prejudice Towards Refugees," Behavioral Sciences, 2025. University of Plymouth / Keele University.

"Seventy-six participants (38 males, 38 females, M_age = 21.5, age ranged took part in total...

...**recruited from Edge Hill University** using opportunity sampling and the Sona system."

BUT HOW CAN WE, AS GAME WRITERS, INCREASE PLAYERS' MEDIA LITERACY?

- ❑ **Increase your own level of media literacy.**

Research is a writer's best friend.

- ❑ **Avoid “dumbing down” the narrative to chase a wider audience.**

Playtest early and often for comprehension and gameplay/UX insights, but ultimately, you need to trust that your audience can handle complexity.

BUT HOW CAN WE, AS GAME WRITERS, INCREASE PLAYERS' MEDIA LITERACY?

- ❑ **Increase your own level of media literacy.**
Research is a writer's best friend.
- ❑ **Avoid “dumbing down” the narrative to chase a wider audience.**
Playtest early and often for comprehension and gameplay/UX insights, but ultimately, you need to trust that your audience can handle complexity.
- ❑ **Utilize a wide array of literary devices to make your point.**
Metaphor, subtext, satire, etc. are all powerful tools to convey a theme.

DON'T FORGET THE WRITER'S TOOLBOX



(this toolbox is a metaphor)

Subtext

Satire

Allegory

Hyperbole

Juxtaposition

Analogy

Allusion

Symbolism

Metaphor

Simile

Motifs

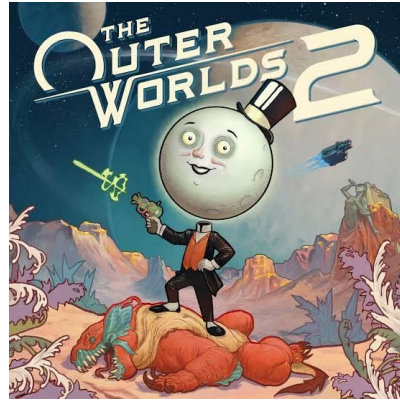
Verisimilitude

EXAMPLES INCLUDE BUT NOT LIMITED TO:



SYMBOLISM

Red: Authoritarianism
Blue: Independent Thought



SATIRE

The absurdity of
late-stage
capitalism.



MOTIF

Questioning your
own existence and
the search for
meaning.



ALLEGORY

A fictitious game
studio's rise and fall,
told over the span of
50 games.

BUT HOW CAN WE, AS GAME WRITERS, INCREASE PLAYERS' MEDIA LITERACY?

- ❑ **Increase your own level of media literacy.**
Research is a writer's best friend.
- ❑ **Avoid “dumbing down” the narrative to chase a wider audience.**
Playtest early and often for comprehension and gameplay/UX insights, but ultimately, you need to trust that your audience can handle narrative complexity.
- ❑ **Utilize a wide array of literary devices to make your point.**
Metaphor, subtext, satire, etc. are all powerful tools to convey a theme.

01: Why We Are Here

02: Polarization

03: The Attention Economy

04: Media Literacy

05: Takeaways

01: Why We Are Here

02: Polarization

03: The Attention Economy

04: Media Literacy

05: Takeaways

WHY WE'RE HERE

POLARIZATION

ATTENTION

MEDIA LITERACY

TAKEAWAYS

HOW TO START A CONVERSATION WITH LEADERSHIP ABOUT A CONTROVERSIAL CHOICE

- **Ensure it's a private conversation in real time**
- **Clearly identify the issue.**
- **Bring data and solutions.**
- **Be curious. Ask questions.**
- **Listen with an open mind.**
- **Engage in good faith discussion and demonstrate mutual respect.**

WHAT IF THEY SAY NO?



OPOSSUM ATTACK!!!!

WHAT IF THEY SAY NO?

- **Take a breath.**
- **Be curious. Ask questions.**
 - “Can we dig into your reaction?”
 - “Do you have an idea for alternative solutions?”
- **Listen with an open mind.**
- **Engage in good faith discussion and demonstrate mutual respect.**
 - Assume that you both want the same thing: To ship a great game.

BUT WHAT ELSE CAN I DO?

- ❑ **Determine your core values - as a person, as a developer, an artist.**
- ❑ **Evaluate your own ability to reflect critically on the games you play and the stories you read. Identify where you can improve.**
- ❑ **Familiarize yourself with the aforementioned tools.**
- ❑ **Advocate with your toolbox not just in the writers' room, but in the designers' room too**
- ❑ **ABC - Always Be Curious**



BE THE CHANGE YOU WISH TO SEE IN THE INDUSTRY



WHY WE'RE HERE

POLARIZATION

ATTENTION

MEDIA LITERACY

TAKEAWAYS

**THANK YOU,
AND
GOOD LUCK!**

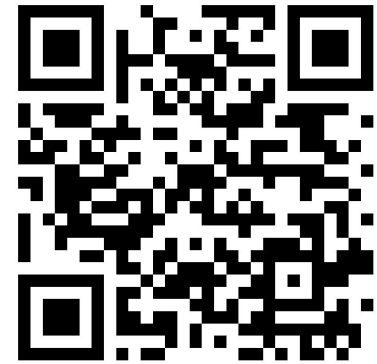
LINK TO SOURCES AND SLIDES



WhatAreMyCoreValues.org



[More Pictures of Lily](#)



GameDevDolin.com